AHEAD WITH KK

Your shop starts before your door: an entry checklist

for any local business with a shop, clinic, office or studio

> **What I saw.** On my way to a Bangalore mall: jewellery ads on the metro platform, the mall in the train window, brand banners on the front saying which floor, and a giant festival doll at the door. My take: most of the decision to spend happens before you walk in.

Walk the path your customer walks, and check:

☐ 1. Google

- Search your business name and your category + area. Are your photos recent? Hours right? Phone number working? Replies to reviews?

☐ 2. Directions

- Is your Google pin exact? Is there a landmark in your listing ("next to the metro exit")?

☐ 3. Your board

- Readable from across the road in 2 seconds? Lit at night? Kannada and English?

☐ 4. Your entrance

- Clean, open, something worth looking at. One seasonal touch (like the mall's festival doll) gives people a reason to stop, and to take a photo.

☐ 5. The first 5 seconds inside

- What does someone see first? A friendly hello, a clear price, your bestseller.

☐ 6. Fix the first tired thing

- One broken light, one faded poster, one old photo on Google. Fix it this week.

Practical steps, not guaranteed results.